

漢字

KANJIDOKU

Sudoku that leaves you with a word

5 puzzles from the book

There are 100 in it.



Nine characters, not nine numbers

Kanjidoku is sudoku. If you have done a sudoku you already know the rule, and it does not change: every row, every column and every outlined box must contain each character exactly once.

The only difference is that the nine symbols are kanji instead of the digits 1 to 9. You do not need to know what they mean to solve the grid. A symbol is a symbol. But every puzzle prints its characters in a numbered key at the top of the page, with readings and meanings, and by the time you have written 火 nine times in nine different places you will find you know it.

That is the whole idea. Nobody learns a character by looking at it once. You learn it by needing it.

IF THE CHARACTERS LOOK LIKE SOUP

They will, at first, and there is a legitimate shortcut. The key numbers every character from 1 to 9. Solve the grid in pencil using the numbers, then go back and write the characters in. You get the puzzle and the writing practice, in that order, and after three or four grids most people stop needing the numbers.

THE TWO TECHNIQUES YOU NEED

The last empty seat

Look at a single cell. Cross off every character that already appears in its row, its column and its box. If exactly one character survives, it goes there.

The only home left

Look at a single row, column or box and pick one character. Cross off every cell in that unit where the character cannot go. If exactly one cell survives, the character goes there.

No puzzle in this book needs anything harder than those two. If you find yourself wanting to guess, there is a move you have not spotted yet.

The word at the end

Two or three cells in every grid are shaded and carry a small number. They are always empty at the start, so you cannot read the word without solving the puzzle first.

When the grid is full, read those cells in numbered order. You will have a real Japanese word, built out of characters you have just spent twenty minutes with. Write it into the boxes at the foot of the page with its reading and meaning; the answer is at the back alongside the solved grid.

WORKED EXAMPLE

① 昨	末	向	期	今	日
期	日	今	向	末	昨
今	昨	末	日	向	期
日	向	期	末	昨	今
末	期	昨	今	② 日	向
向	今	日	昨	期	末

This grid is already solved.

Cells 1 and 2 are shaded. Read them in that order:

昨日 ^{kinō}きのう
yesterday

Both characters were in the key at the top of the page all along, so you already have the reading and the meaning.

HOW THIS SAMPLE IS ORDERED

The grids grow one step at a time. Six by six, then seven, eight and nine. Each size needs exactly that many characters, which is why the sets stay tight instead of padded. The four-by-fours are in Volume One.

Two of them are jigsaws. Boxes have to be rectangles, so the size has to divide: nine is three by three, six is two by three. Five and seven are prime and cannot be cut up at all, so those grids use irregular regions instead.

Easier characters first. Every grid here is N3, so there is no easier level to put first. The sets are ordered by how common their characters are in print.

Some characters will be familiar. The grids are built around N3, but a set uses an N5 or N4 character where the theme wants one, so the hidden words can be real words. The index gives every character its level; the writing practice covers the N3 ones.

Yesterday

① 日 hi nichi jitsu
ひ / ニチ・ジツ
day; sun

② 向 mu ku kō
む(く) / コウ
to face; direction

③ 昨 saku
サク
yesterday; previous

④ 今 ima kon kin
いま / コン・キン
now

⑤ 期 ki go
キ・ゴ
period; time

⑥ 末 sue matsu batsu
すえ / マツ・バツ
end; close

①	末	向	期		
期			向		
	昨		日		
		期		昨	
		昨		②	向
		日	昨	期	

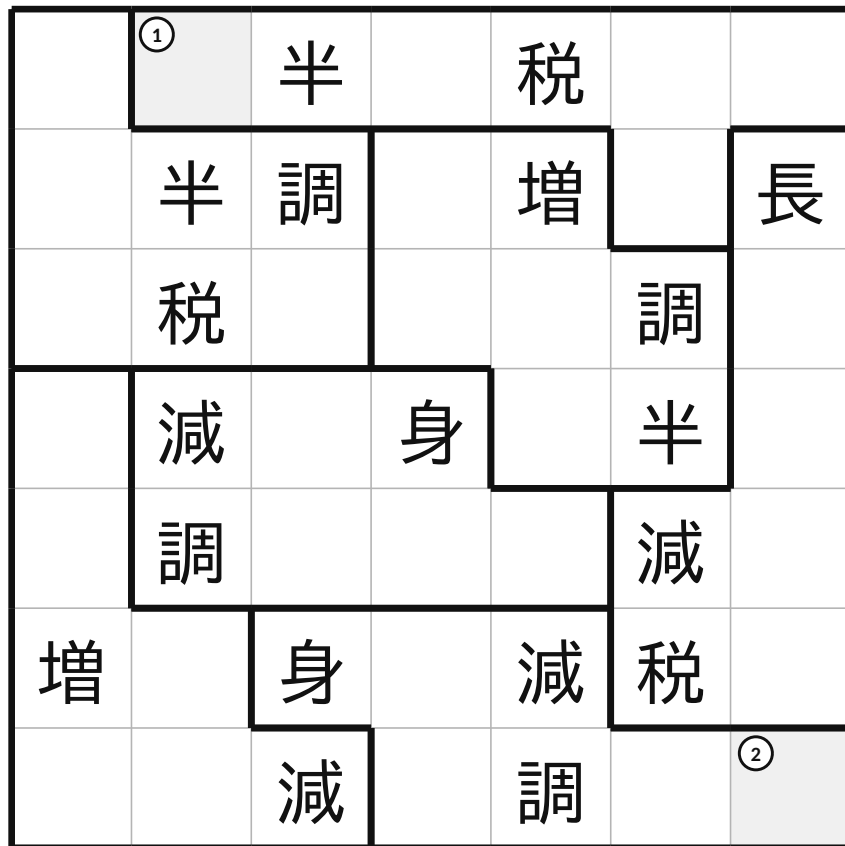
THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2

reading _____
meaning _____

Putting the tax up

- ① 長 ^{naga i}なが(い) / ^{chō}チョウ
long; leader
- ② 調 ^{shira beru}しら(べる) / ^{chō}チョウ
to look into; a tone
- ③ 身 ^{mi shin}み / シン
the body; oneself
- ④ 半 ^{naka ba}なか(ば) / ^{han}ハン
half; middle
- ⑤ 減 ^{he ru}へ(る) / ^{gen}ゲン
dwindle; decrease
- ⑥ 増 ^{ma su}ま(す) / ^{zō}ゾウ
increase; add
- ⑦ 税 ^{zei}ゼイ
tax; duty



THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading _____

meaning _____

Being critical

① 批 hi
ヒ
to criticise

② 判 judgement; a seal
waka ru han ban
わか(る) / ハン・バン

③ 的 mato teki
まと / テキ
a target; -ic, -al

④ 知 shi ru chi
し(る) / チ
know; wisdom

⑤ 私 watakushi shi
わたくし / シ
private; I

⑥ 公 ōyake kō ku
おおやけ / コウ・ク
public; official

⑦ 設 mō keru setsu
もう(ける) / セツ
to set up

⑧ 表 omote hyō
おもて / ヒョウ
surface; table

	表			批	設	知	
	批	知					公
私			知	③			
	的	批	表				
				知	公	私	
				判			的
的	②				知	公	
	私	設	公			的	①

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2	3
---	---	---

reading _____
meaning _____

Not yet official

① 政 politics;
government
matsurigoto sei shō
まつりごと / セイ・ショウ

② 教 teach; faith
oshi eru kyō
おし(える) / キョウ

③ 務 tsuto meru mu
つと(める) / ム
task; duties

④ 党 tō
トウ
party; faction

⑤ 内 uchi nai dai
うち / ナイ・ダイ
inside; within

⑥ 情 feelings; emotion
nasa ke jō sei
なさ(け) / ジョウ・セイ

⑦ 示 shime su ji shi
しめ(す) / ジ・シ
show; indicate

⑧ 公 ōyake kō ku
おおやけ / コウ・ク
public; official

⑨ 定 determine; fix
sada meru tei jō
さだ(める) / テイ・ジョウ

情	党					教		
務	教	政	情					
①						党	定	
			教			政		公
	務			公			示	
党		公			政			
	定	党						
					示	公	党	務
		務				②	内	教

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2
---	---

reading

meaning

The first night

① 出 exit; leave

de ru shutsu sui
で(る) / シュツ・スイ

② 張 ha ru chō
は(る) / チョウ
lengthen; stretch

③ 突 tsu ku totsū ka
つ(く) / トツ・カ
to thrust; to stick out

④ 追 ō tsui
お(う) / ツイ
to chase; to follow

⑤ 拡 broaden; extend
hiro garu kaku kō
ひろ(がる) / カク・コウ

⑥ 演 en
エン
performance; act

⑦ 舞 ma u bu
ま(う) / ブ
to dance

⑧ 初 haji me sho
はじ(め) / ショ
first time; beginning

⑨ 台 dai tai
ダイ・タイ
a stand; a platform

	張			追			突	
突		演						③
	初	台	張	出				
	台	追	初			演		
演	②							張
		突			台	舞	初	
				舞	拡	台	出	
						突		追
	突			台		①	張	

THE HIDDEN WORD

1	2	3

reading

meaning

Solutions

Characters in grey are the ones you had to work out; black ones were given. The note under each word is the reason that word was worth hiding.

① 昨	末	向	期	今	日
期	日	今	向	末	昨
今	昨	末	日	向	期
日	向	期	末	昨	今
末	期	昨	今	② 日	向
向	今	日	昨	期	末

3. YESTERDAY

昨日 ^{kinō}きのう
yesterday

昨 means the one just past, so 昨日 is yesterday and 昨年 (さくねん, sakunen) is last year. The reading here is irregular and worth memorising as a lump: kinou, not sakujitsu, though the second does exist and sounds like a form.

身	① 増	半	調	税	長	減
減	半	調	税	増	身	長
長	税	増	減	身	調	半
調	減	税	身	長	半	増
税	調	長	増	半	減	身
増	長	身	半	減	税	調
半	身	減	長	調	増	② 税

7. PUTTING THE TAX UP

増税 ^{zōzei}ぞうぜい
a tax increase

増 is increase and 減 is decrease, and both attach to 税 for the thing every government does one of: 増税 and 減税 (げんぜい, genzei). Put the two together and 増減 (ぞうげん, zōgen) is fluctuation, up and down as one word.

公	表	私	的	批	設	知	判
判	批	知	設	私	的	表	公
私	公	判	知	③ 的	表	批	設
設	的	批	表	公	私	判	知
批	設	的	判	知	公	私	表
表	知	公	私	判	批	設	的
的	② 判	表	批	設	知	公	私
知	私	設	公	表	判	的	① 批

25. BEING CRITICAL

批判的 ^{hihanteki}ひはんてき
critical; judgmental

批判 is criticism and 的 turns almost any noun into an adjective, so 批判的 is critical. 的 is worth learning properly because it is everywhere: 知的 (ちてき, chiteki) is intellectual, 私的 (してき, shiteki) is private, 公的 (こうてき, kōteki) is official.

情	党	定	公	示	内	教	務	政
務	教	政	情	党	定	示	公	内
①内	公	示	務	政	教	党	定	情
定	示	内	教	務	党	政	情	公
政	務	教	定	公	情	内	示	党
党	情	公	示	内	政	務	教	定
公	定	党	内	教	務	情	政	示
教	内	情	政	定	示	公	党	務
示	政	務	党	情	公	②定	内	教

47. NOT YET OFFICIAL

内定 naitei
ないてい
an unofficial offer

内 is inside and 定 is settled, so a 内定 is a decision that has been made inside but not announced yet. For a Japanese student it is the job offer that arrives months before graduation: fixed, celebrated, and still officially nothing at all.

拡	張	舞	台	追	演	出	突	初
突	出	演	舞	拡	初	張	追	③台
追	初	台	張	出	突	拡	演	舞
出	台	追	初	張	舞	演	拡	突
演	④舞	初	拡	突	出	追	台	張
張	拡	突	追	演	台	舞	初	出
初	追	張	突	舞	拡	台	出	演
台	演	拡	出	初	張	突	舞	追
舞	突	出	演	台	追	⑤初	張	拡

85. THE FIRST NIGHT

初舞台 hatsubutai
はつぶたい
a first appearance on stage

舞台 is a stage and 初 is first, so a 初舞台 is a debut. 台 is a stand or platform and it is everywhere in Japanese, holding up everything from a stage to a kitchen counter.

Writing it out

Solving teaches you to recognise a character. Writing teaches you to remember it. Trace the grey model, then fill the rest of the row from memory.

Two rules of stroke order cover most characters: **top before bottom**, and **left before right**. Where they conflict, a horizontal stroke usually comes before the vertical one crossing it. 十 is drawn across, then down. Stroke order is not pedantry. It is what keeps a character legible when you write it quickly, and it is how a paper dictionary is indexed.

The dotted cross is there so you can judge proportion. Most of a character's legibility lives in how it sits in the square rather than in the strokes themselves.

日				day hi ひ	向				to face muku む (く)
昨				yesterday saku サク	今				now ima いま
期				period ki キ	末				end sue すえ
長				long nagai なが (い)	調				to look into shiraberu しら (べる)
身				the body mi み	半				half nakaba なか (ば)
減				dwindle heru へ (る)	増				increase masu ま (す)
税				tax zei ゼイ	批				to criticise hi ヒ
判				judgement wakaru わか (る)	的				a target mato まと
知				know shiru し (る)	私				private watakushi わたくし

There are ninety-five more

Volume Two holds **100 puzzles** and every character of N3, each with its readings and meaning printed on the page you meet it.

Full solutions. Every grid worked out, with the hidden word, its reading and a note on where the word turns up in real Japanese.

A complete index. All 497 characters, with every puzzle each one appears in, for when one turns up three grids later and you cannot place it.

Writing practice. Squares to write in for every character in the book, with a grey model to trace and the stroke-order rules explained.

THE SERIES

Kanjidoku N5 and N4. Where the series starts, and the one book that comes before this one: about 280 characters, six four-by-four warm-ups, and the vocabulary the grids here assume you already have.

Kanjidoku N2. Another 380 or so. Longer compounds, more abstract words, and grids that hide four-character phrases.

Kanjidoku N1. Everything left. Nobody finishes N1 in a hurry.

PLEASE SHARE THIS

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KANJIDOKU.NET for the rest of the series, and the other samplers



MIND QUESTS